

ABOUT ME

Pre-Doctoral Fellow at UChicago Booth in Quantitative Marketing with Professor Andreas Kraft.
Researches how language models shape the way humans perceive the world, and how to improve language models by drawing inspiration from human cognition.
Graduated with M.S. in Data Science from The University of Chicago.
Earned bachelor's degrees in Economics, Finance, and History as a triple major at The Ohio State University.
Experienced in teaching roles across STEM fields, including Statistics.

PUBLICATIONS

When to Think Fast and Slow? AMOR: Adaptive Entropy Gate for Hybrid Models
Under review · ICLR 2027

Conceptizer: Next-Token Prediction Is Not All You Need
Under review · ACL Rolling Review

Can You Tell a Smile from a Veil? How Buyers Respond to AI Written Listings in Government Auctions
Working paper · preprint forthcoming

Do AIs Dream of Electric Butterflies? Benchmarking LLM Consciousness via Theory-Grounded Self-Reports
PsyArXiv preprint · Oct 2025

SCENE: Evaluating Explainable AI Techniques Using Soft Counterfactuals
arXiv preprint · Aug 2024

LINKS

Personal Website:
haoranzhengraul.github.io

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linkedin.com/in/haoran-zheng-04a9551ba

HAORAN ZHENG

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Chicago, IL, USA

AI RESEARCHER

WORK EXPERIENCE

Dr. Andreas Kraft
The University of Chicago Booth School of Business
Jun 2025 – Present

Research Professional in Quantitative Marketing
- Working on firm behavior in fuel-market research and related projects, including geolocating gas stations relative to highways, designing a simulated eBay-style marketplace, finding new datasets for potential research, and cleaning, labeling and analyzing large-scale data (28+ TB, 168 billion rows).

Dr. Nicholas Epley
The University of Chicago Booth School of Business
Sep 2024 – Jun 2025

Research Assistant in Behavioral Science
- Led studies on how people across cultures perceive each other's beliefs and preferences ("The Multicultural Study").

Mindworks Lab
The University of Chicago Booth School of Business
Apr 2024 – Jun 2025

Research Specialist in Behavioral Science
- Examined frontier behavioral science research on prospect theory and diminishing sensitivity.
- Co-managed studies and collected data for Dr. Alexander Todorov and Dr. Sarah Sebo.

Dr. Christopher Reed
The Ohio State University
Apr 2024 – May 2025

Research Assistant in History
- Applied modern NLP techniques and the SCENE method to traditional history research, identifying the significance of previously unseen historical documents.

China Automotive Systems
NASDAQ: CAAS
May 2021 – May 2023

Financial Analyst
- Conducted financial analysis and modeling for automotive industry applications.

The Ohio State University
Feb 2021 – May 2022

Lead Teaching Assistant for Statistics 2320
- Taught two weekly recitations for 65 students each, focusing on statistical concepts and analytical tools (R).
- Developed customized review notes and visual aids for 900+ enrolled students each semester.

EDUCATION

The University of Chicago
Chicago, IL
2024

Master of Science in Data Science
- GPA 4.0/4.0.
- Thesis: "Demystifying the Black Box: Evaluations of Explainable AI Techniques in NLP" (Advisor: Dr. Utku Pamuksuz).

The Ohio State University
Columbus, OH
2022

Bachelor of Science in Economics
- Triple major in Economics (GPA 3.9/4.0), Finance (GPA 3.8/4.0), and History (GPA 3.8/4.0).
- Pace Setters Award (top 1% of students).

ACTIVITIES

- Soccer: played for the Columbus Crew (Major League Soccer) reserve team, 2016–17 season.
- E-sports: competed professionally in Pro Evolution Soccer 2017; ranked 45th on the American continental server; semifinalist at the US National Championship.
- Muay Thai & kickboxing: sanctioned bouts (1–1 record).